Princess Cyra of Brightmoon - Tactical Genius

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Princess Cyra of Brightmoon - Tactical Genius

by Bagge

Summary

Princess Cyra, daughter of Glimmer of Brightmoon and Catra of the Frightzone, faces the greatest challenge of her young life - she is going to ask a pretty girl to prom.

Notes

My entry for the first prompt of the Sheracrackshipweekend2023 fan event: Summer fling.

I borrowed Princess Cyra of Brightmoon from Jid123 - a cute and demure princess who just so happens to plot for world domination in her spare time. Moahahahaha!

See the end of the work for more notes

Cyra walked down the shining castle corridor, her long gown trailing after her, her tail swishing. Everything in Brightmoon sparkles, as usual. Floor, walls, gems, waterfalls. But nothing sparkles as much as her, as should be. Her, the princess. Daughter of Queen Glimmer and High Counsellor Catra themselves. One day poised to inherit the throne, and with it all the power of the High Queen of Etheria.

Cyra allowed herself a little smile. One day. She felt a maniacal laughter bubble up, but she forced it down. Time and place. One day they would all see her for who she really was - when it was time for the velvet glove to come off and the iron fist to rule them all to be shown. But until then, it was best if they all saw her as demure little princess Cyra.

"Morning Cyra," a friendly voice said. For a moment, a stab of irritation flashed through her brain. Cyra preferred to be addressed by title. Then again, as he was married to one of her mothers, she supposed Queen Consort Bow could be allowed a certain amount of liberty (also, she was genuinely fond of him, friendly soul as he was). Still, there was no reason to waste this opportunity to educate. In contrast to her, the man had not been raised in the royal court, and could not be expected to at all times uphold the proper protocol.

"And a good morning to you, Queen Consort," she nodded. "I trust your morning has been fulfilling."

"It's been great," Bow happily said. "After I got Perfuma and Scorpia installed, I took Arbalest and Glow to the tailor. They are really excited for princess prom."

"An excitement I think it's fair to say we all share," Cyra said without her expression or tone of voice changing even the slightest. "Princess Prom is a monumental event, after all."

"We are going back for adjustments in a few days if you want to come," Bow offered. Cyra had to hide a disdainful smile.

"That won't be necessary," she calmly said instead.

As if her dress had not been ready for months.

As if she would leave *anything* to chance at a time like this.

"Suit yourself," Bow said, unperturbed by the brush-off. He glanced at her. "So, Glow is trying to find a partner for prom..."

"Then I would suggest Glow to ask a presumed partner herself, rather than leave the deed to her father," Cyra said, slightly more snippy than strictly needed. She saw Bow's shoulders drop and decided to take pity on him. It was not that she disliked her half-sister, but she had grander designs "...although I would also suggest that if she were to ask Princess Symponia of Salineas, it would not be entirely unwelcome."

"Really?" Bow said, perking up in a way that Cyra had to admit was downright adorable. Sometimes she understood what her mother saw in the man.

"Really," Cyra confirmed. She smiled that confidential little smile her grandfather was so fond of and patted Bow on the hand. "I have promised not to tell Glow this, but Symphonia happens to be quite smitten with her. If only one of them is to work up the courage to ask the other, it will all work out quite satisfyingly for both of them."

"Wow, thank you," Bow said with an earnest smile. "I will see if I can give them a little nudge..."

"I know you can act with discretion if needed," Cyra lied. She comforted herself with that Bow at least would be more subtle at playing match maker than Symphonia's father Sea Hawk, were he to attempt it.

"You have no partner for Prom yet, then?"

"Wheels are in motion, Queen Consort," Cyra said, unable to keep in a smug smile. "Wheels are in motion."

"Oh, I will leave you to it then," Bow laughed, clearly thought of ruffling her hair but - mercifully - thought the better of it.

"I give you thanks, Queen-Concort," Cyra primly said and walked on through the corridors, towards the eastern garden.

Wheels where indeed in motion.

One might be forgiven to think Cyra's choice of where to take her stroll was just pure happenstance.

One might think her choice of wardrobe for the day - a pale blue, backless dress with long sleeves and a tiara with black gems, going well with her long, pink hair - was simply a result of the young princess being gifted with a (regrettably rare, in her family) sense of fashion rather than the result of hours and hours before the mirror, culminating in this very moment.

One might think that Cyra was not fully aware of who else could be expected to be in the eastern garden this morning.

As if Cyra did not know perfectly well that the honeycup flowers Deathclaw (named after her grandmother) loved would be in full bloom, and that Deathclaw (who usually went by the nickname Clawy) would be found visiting them, on this her first morning in Brightmoon during this visit.

And thus, Cyra, Princess of Brightmoon and future High Queen of Etheria went with the calm steps of the one who is truly prepared to face the largest, most dire challenge of her young life.

She was going to ask a pretty girl to prom.

Calmly - not letting any of her inner turmoil be seen - Cyra entered the garden. As planned, Princess Deathclaw of Plumeria was standing by the honeycup bed, admiring the bloom. She was... breathtaking, carapase polished until it gleamed, dressed in a simple yet spotless tunic of plumerian cut.

Princess Deathclaw was - besides astonishingly beautiful - tidy, a trait Cyra enjoyed a great deal.

"Good morning, Princess Deathclaw," Cyra said, calmly walking up to her friend. "A lovely morning, isn't it?"

"Cyra! "Princess Deathclaw beamed at her. "It's so great to see you again." She held out her arms for a bear hug, hesitated and gave Cyra a glance to see if it would be reciprocated.

Passion and impulsiveness, but self control enough to choose whether to act on it. Cyra liked that in a girl. As reward, she stepped within arms length of the larger girl and held out her arms in a gesture of accepting the hug despite not normally being a touchy feely kind of person, which signalled coolness and affection and not in any way shyness.

Clawy scoped her up in a bear hug that made Cyra loose her breath due to the suddenness of the movement and her lung movements being restricted and not in any manner because of sudden proximity to bulging muscles, a scent of flowers and sweat intermixed or the feeling of weightlessness that came from being swept off her feet by someone who was at the same time strong as a monster yet gentle as a flower, and who truly treasured her...

"I said, how have you been?" Clawy asked, causing Cyra to realise that she had been too caught up in the hug (in a physical sense, of course - nothing else) to notice that the younger princess had spoken to her.

"Fine, she said, slightly out of breath (again, only from the compression of her lunge, not from something as childish as a crush). "I have been perfectly fine. And I hope the same can be said for you?"

"Oh, I've been great," Clawy said. "Did you know, mom went to the Frightzone to clean up some of the old junk together with auntie 'trapta, and me and Echo got to tag along, and there we found..."

As Clawy's breathless tirade washed over her, Cyra went through the last steps of her plan in her mind.

Everything was in place.

The garden.,

The hug (even if it in Cyra's plan had been referred to as a 'warm greeting').

Now to enact the next step.

"Clawy," Cyra said, forcing her voice to remain calm. "Would you please keep me company as we stroll through the garden."

"Oh, sure," Clawy said with that enthusiastic naivitie that was so becoming. "Lead the way."

Bless her soul, she really made it too easy.

Not that Cyra needed this to be easy. 'Easy' was a crutch to lean on for insufficient planners. And Cyra had planned for every eventuality.

With deliberate nonchalance she held out her hand and she felt her heart flutter when Clawy gently put her claw in it. Cyra led her down one of the winding paths of the garden, as always marvelling at the readiness with which the other princess followed her lead. Despite being a year her junior, the Plumerian princess was easily a head taller and already stronger than most adults. To have a being of such power under her control, willing to follow her smallest touch was... intoxicating.

They had danced together a year ago, just for a short while during one of mommy Glimmer's princess classes. Cyra still savoured the trill that dance gave. Could still remember the butterflies in her stomach.

And soon she would have more - would have so much more - when she led her date to the dance floor at Princess Prom...

"Cyra! Look!" Clawy gasped. Cyra allowed herself an inward little smile.

"What is it?" she asked with perfectly innocent voice. As if she didn't know.

"It's the cutest thing ever!" Clawy breathed. Cyra gave the baby turtles in the pond a content look. She had made sure they were there earlier this very morning. And if they hadn't been, she had scouted no less than five other suitable cute landmarks throughout the garden.

"They are adorable," she said and glanced at the awestruck Clawy.

Right.

It was time.

Everything was perfect. All that remained was for Cyra to ask the question.

She took a deep breath, and then another one.

She swallowed once. She realised should have included to drink a glass of water in her preparations, since the dryness of her mouth told her she was dangerously dehydrated.

That was of no consequence. She could do this.

"Clawy..." she begun, which was a strong opening, and one she had practised several times in front of the mirror the last few days.

"Yes, Cyra?"

Now came the hard part.

"Would you..."

"Yes?"

Deep breath. "Would you perhaps consider..."

"Consider what?"

"...consider walking a bit further with me?"

"Oooooh, I'd love that."

Curses! Treacherous tongue!

But Cyra was not beaten yet. A good general never assumed victory at first contact with the enemy.

Or 'stunningly beautiful girl that made your heart go pitter-patter', whichever it might be. (Her mothers insisted those things could be synonymous, but this was not the time for boring mom-stuff. This was the time for Cyra to get ahead of the game).

"Oh, Clawy... would you look at that!"

"Huh, the bridge is broken."

The little ornamental bridge that allowed passage over the small, carefully sculpted stream was in fact broken, another little preparation from Cyra's side - even if it never would be traced back to her. She looked up at gave Clawy her most trusting smile - practised to perfection on Grandpa Micah.

"Could I ask you to help me across the stream, Clawy?" she breathed, and then she sharply drew her breath as Clawy lifted her - as easy if she had been a kitten - and stepped over the stream in one long stride.

Cyra had to suppress a delighted squee. Clawy's strong claws held her as delicately as if she had been a doll, and she soared over the stream. It felt like flying. No, it felt much *better* than flying, which was pretty boring and messed up her fur. This was pure bliss. Being held and carried like the precious princess she was. She completely entrusting her magnificent partner with her body, with her entire self. The power of the other princess her disposal.

After an eternity - and yet far too soon - she landed on the other side of the creek. Clawy gently - of course gently - put her down and beamed proudly at her.

"There you are, Cyra. Right as rain."

Now!

"Thank you so much, Clawy. Incidentally there was something I'd like to ask you."

"Oh? What is it?"

"I hope you would not find it too forward if I were to ask you to to follow me to..."

"...to what?"

CURSES!

Deep breath.

"Princess Deathclaw. I want you to know that I hold you in the deepest regard, and as such..."

"Um...?"

Shit, wrong part of the prepared speech.

"I mean, do you want to..."

Clawy grinned and leaned down slightly, looking Cyra in the eyes.

"Cyra, what are you talking about?"

Cyra realised she had planned for every eventuality - but not this. She had not planned for Deathclaw's beautiful brown eyes to be at eye level with herself.

Enact the panic option!

"Gazebo!" she managed to to breath.

"Gazebo?" Clawy frowned.

"Do... do you want... want to follow me to the... Gazebo..." Cyra managed to get out.

"THAT'S what you wanted to say," Clawy laughed. "Of course. Let's go to the Gazebo."

And with Cyra slowly regaining her breath as they walked, they strolled together to the Gazebo.

To the waiting picknick.

Cyra had intended the picknick to be a celebration of a successful campaign, a shared victory between her and her prom date. But as it were, it would have to serve as a last, desperate attempt to overcome the accursed tongue numbness and ask Princes Deathclaw to attend Princess Prom together with her.

The Gazebo was one of her favourite hideouts in the castle. Painted in purple and pink and with little turrets to hide behind. When she was younger she used to pretend it was her very own castle, from which she could plot her campaign against the surrounding kingdoms.

But this time, what she had in mind was no child's game. And the campaign she waged was of uttermost importance.

Clawy happily chattered about life in Plumeria as they walked. Normally, inane nonsense like that tried Cyra's patience, but when it came from Clawy, it was simply charming. It helped that the other princess' voice was drop dead gorgeous - just like everything about her, really.

"Clawy, it would be a delight for me, could I treat you to a simple breakfast," Cyra said as they entered the Gazebo, having had time to collect herself during the walk.

"Oh wow!" Clawy said, taking in the multitude of food, snacks, fruit and drinks with an expression so eager and honest that it made Cyra's heart melt. "Have you made all this yourself?"

"I might have had some help..." Cyra modestly lied. As if she would have left something of this importance to others. "Please, sit down with me..." Strategically, the two cushions were placed just next to each other, and with Clawy leaning against the wall - why, it just so happened that the best way for Cyra to sit was just next to her, practically in her lap.

What a coincidence.

"I trust everything is to your pleasure," Cyra modestly said a few minutes later, as they had started to dig in to the feast.

"This is amazing," Clawy beamed. "You are amazing for putting this together."

Cyra felt a warmth spreading up her neck, over her cheek. Normally this annoyed her, because she felt blushing to be unbecoming of someone of her station.

But here and now, it might be to her advantage. Cyra knew perfectly well that most people regarded her as cute - a pink and brown furred little kitten, far too quick to dismiss her claws or sparks. And if that was was it took to land a date with the most marvellous princess of Etheria, then so be it.

She forced herself to breath normally. She leaned backwards and looked up into Deathclaws large eyes. She felt her will rapidly evaporate but forced herself to remain on track.

"Clawy..." she begun. Then she had to take a breath not to pass out as the other girl smiled at her.

"Cyra?" Clawy said.

"Would you do me the honour of..."

"The honour of what?"

NOW!

"honour of... passing me the salt?"

"Um... sure?"

RUINATION! DAMNATION!

Cyra cursed her cravenness. She was the daughter of Catra of the Frightzone and Glimmer of Brightmoon. Her mother were two of the most dangerous women of Etheria. They command armies. They had once - separately and together - nearly had the entire world under their heel. So why was it so impossible for Cyra to spit out the words of a mere proposal for a date?

Admittedly, a date with a girl that made her knees week and butterflies flutter in her stomach.

To the most important social gathering of their entire lives.

And with the clear implication of an intention for a... deeper relationship.

Not that it mattered, if Cyra couldn't get the words over her lips.

She would NOT admit defeat.

"Clawy, do you want to... pass me the pepper too?"

Defeat.

Failure.

Black despair.

Cyra would die, alone and forgotten, never having felt the warmth of love. It was so clear now, that the pleasures of the world was not for her. Only solitude and heartache remained.

"Here you go," Princess Deathclaw happily said as she fumbled with the small salt and pepper shakers, too busy with the food to notice Cyra's inner turmoil. "Oh, also I wanted to ask you something."

Cyra simply nodded, not daring to trust her voice.

"Do you want to go to Princess Prom with me?"

Cyra stared at the other princess, her mouth forming a perfect O.

"I know it's still some time left," Clawy went on, her smile widening, "but I wanted to make sure no one else snagged a cutie like you first." Her expression became earnest. "I really like you, Cyra. We have fun together, and I really love dancing with you. I think we could have a great night at prom. What do you say?"

The look she gave Cyra would have melted her heart, had it not already formed a puddle by her feet.

"That... that might be acceptable," Cyra whispered.

End Notes

No, YOU are writing Wensday/Enid-fanfic badly disguised as a next gen She-Ra story

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!